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Hammer

1.12.1 Hammer

References:

Hebrew הַלְמוּת (halmuth) JDG 5:26

Hebrew מַקָּבָת (maqavah, maqeveth) JDG 4:21, 1KI 6:7, ISA 44:12, JER 10:4

Hebrew מִקְשָׁה (miqshah) EXO 25:18, EXO 25:31, EXO 25:36, EXO 37:7, EXO 37:17, EXO 37:22, NUM 8:4, NUM 8:4, NUM 10:2

Hebrew פַּטִּישׁ (patish) ISA 41:7, JER 23:29, JER 50:23

Hebrew רִקֻּעַ (riqua‘) NUM 17:3

Greek ἐλατός (elatos) SIR 50:16

Greek ὁλοσφύρητος (olosfurētos) SIR 50:9

Greek σφῦρα (sfura) SIR 38:28

Description:

Wooden hammer (© Giovanni Dall'Orto, Attribution, via Wikimedia Commons)The hammer was an instrument about 30 centimeters (1 foot) long. It had a handle, usually made of wood, to which was attached a stone, wooden, or (less frequently) metal head. The handle was fitted into a hole in the hammer's head.

Usage:

Drawing of a worker using a hammer (Elbert Boot © United Bible Societies)The hammer served many purposes, including the breaking or dressing of building stones, pounding nails or pegs into wood, or pounding pegs into the ground. It also was used by blacksmiths to shape hot metal.

Translation:

The meaning of the Hebrew word *miqshah* is uncertain. It seems to refer to the result of the work of an artisan on metal objects, that is, “hammered work” or “beaten work.”